preferences, fears, or perceptions of a country refer to those of its incumbent leadership in accordance with the "unitary rational actor" assumption.

SIX PROPOSITIONS

The following six propositions delve more deeply into the BRICS' motivations—that is, *why* they collaborate.

Proposition 1. Collective financial statecraft among the BRICS countries is more likely when collaboration magnifies the signal to the incumbent powers that the BRICS are dissatisfied with current global financial governance.

The BRICS, as intermediate and/or newly arrived and insecure major powers, are unhappy with the state of global financial governance. The rising economic status of the BRICS, their particular preferences and voices, are not proportionally reflected or fairly represented in the current global governance system. The incumbent powers, due to the path-dependence of institutions and domestic resistance, are unwilling to agree to share their privileges. Furthermore, the BRICS countries tend to have revisionist preferences for specific substantive components of contemporary global financial governance.[4] Hence, they have a common interest in increasing their representation, status, and voice in the global financial system. It is no coincidence that BRICS collaboration expanded in the aftermath of the global financial crisis, when core country financial practices, particularly in the United States, became somewhat discredited.[5]

Proposition 2. Collective financial statecraft among the BRICS countries is more likely when each country perceives threats to its sovereignty or autonomy to act, particularly in its respective region.

The BRICS countries are "sovereignty hawks": despite power asymmetries, differential speeds of economic growth, being located in different geographic spaces, and dissimilar political regime types and relations with the incumbent powers and the liberal global economic order, the BRICS share common aversions when it comes to protecting their countries' sovereignty and autonomy. They fear and resent interference by the incumbent powers in their internal affairs, autonomy, or independent foreign policy choices. This shared sentiment leads all the BRICS governments to come to the aid of any member whose sovereignty is being